

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

English Language and Literature (184) | CBSE 2026-27

The Midnight Visitor

Footprints Without Feet | Board-examinable literature

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

How does Ausable defeat Max despite not looking like a typical secret agent?

Answer:

He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Max panics and jumps, while Ausable wins through quick thinking rather than physical strength.

Question 2

Why does Fowler's opinion of Ausable change?

Answer:

Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Ausable's clever handling of Max reveals that intelligence and composure matter more than appearance.

Question 3

What makes the balcony story an effective trick?

Answer:

Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure. The trick exploits Max's fear and impatience.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

The central focus is: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

First point: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Second point: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in The Midnight Visitor lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Then connect it to the result: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man.

The Midnight Visitor - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Max panics and jumps, while Ausable wins through quick thinking rather than physical strength. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Ausable's clever handling of Max reveals that intelligence and composure matter more than appearance. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

The first idea is: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. The second idea is: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Effect or outcome: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Next, Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Finally, Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure.

The Midnight Visitor - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Add one supporting point: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. End with the outcome or message: Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure.

Question 14

How should you support an English literature answer from The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

Use a relevant incident, character action, theme, or poetic image: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Then explain what it reveals about the character, situation, or message.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

A sound inference is that ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Then justify the response with: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man.

Question 18

What would make an answer from The Midnight Visitor incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Also add: Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure.

The Midnight Visitor - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

Assertion: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Reason: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from The Midnight Visitor in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

Use three connected points: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. - and close with: Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in The Midnight Visitor be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man.

Question 24

Which detail from The Midnight Visitor is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

The Midnight Visitor - Continued

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

1. He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. 2. Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. 3. Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from The Midnight Visitor before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man.

Question 28

Why does The Midnight Visitor remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from The Midnight Visitor.

Answer:

Opening: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. Development: Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man. Conclusion: Ausable delivers it confidently and supports it with ordinary details, so Max accepts it under pressure. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about The Midnight Visitor?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: He stays calm and invents a believable story about a balcony and an approaching police officer. and Fowler expects a glamorous spy but initially sees an ordinary, unremarkable man.

Sources: CBSE English curriculum 2026-27; CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27; NCERT textbooks.